Ready to start?
Create a task in Odin Production Full Workflow.

+ Create task

ON THIS GUIDE 0/27

01 Overview
- Overview
- Expectations
- Payments
- Pay FAQ
- Important Links
- Time Tracking (Insightful)

02 Recording Workflow
- Recording Workflow
- Technical Setup
- Task Ideation
- Studio Workflow
- How to Record Step By Step
- Workflow Checklist

03 Recording Quality Expectations
- Recording Quality Expectations
- Domain Expertise
- Narration Requirements
- Apps and Desktop
- Onscreen Presentation
- PII, Licensed Content, and AI ...

04 Additional Resources
- Additional Resources
- Golden Examples
- "Good" vs "Bad" Task
- Restricted App List
- Common Mistakes

05 Support
- Technical Issues
- FAQ
- Contacts
- Changelog

RECORDING WORKFLOW

🎥 How to Record Step By Step

How To Record: Step-by-Step

This page explains how to prepare, record, stop, and verify a task.

Quick reference: Odin Writer Cheat Sheet (PDF)

Recording Workflow at a Glance

Step 1. Prepare the Recording

Clean your desktop and prefill all of the fields in Task Recorder.

Accessibility Inspector	**CRITICAL:** Keep Accessibility Inspector running throughout the recording. Close only its window with the red button; do not quit the app. A dot must remain beneath its Dock icon.
TaskRecorder	TaskRecorder 2.4.4 is open, all three permissions are green, the microphone is on, and the correct display is selected. OTA or Google sign-in is not required for the recorder.
Display	The resolution matches Studio, the dock is on the left or right, the clock displays seconds in the menu bar, and the cursor uses its default appearance.
System	The Mac is connected to power and has enough free storage.
Privacy	Personal accounts, notifications, recent files, and private information are hidden
Project Materials	Close or Minimize Studio, Slack, the Writer Guidelines, Google Drive folders, Metadata.rtf, and anything showing Mercor or Project Odin.
Unused Softwares	Quit unused apps, calls, screen-sharing/recording tools, and unnecessary background utilities before starting. Close unused browser tabs and pause nonessential sync or downloads. **Keep TaskRecorder and Accessibility Inspector running**; do not disable required system or security services.
Task Details	Your idea is approved in the Mercor Studio, and the full approval text is pre-filled in Studio Prompt/Description.
Task Apps	Launch, log in to, load, and minimize every genuine task app. No task work has been completed yet.
Input Files	Prepared inputs must follow the requirements in Task Ideation, Step 4.
Opening Doc	Open a document containing only the Goal section of your approval text in Word or Google Docs, or an allowed app. It is the only window visible behind the TaskRecorder. Do not show the Approval ID or the rest of the approval text. **DO NOT** use Notes.app or TextEdit.app.

Prefill TaskRecorder Fields

After preparing the recording environment, complete the TaskRecorder fields before selecting Start Recording. For every new task, check for details left from the previous task and replace them with the current Task Description (Goal) and app list. TaskRecorder 2.4.4 does not require an OTA account or Google sign-in; assigned OTA accounts are retired and no longer apply to task apps.

Field	What to Enter
Task Description	Paste only the **Goal** section of your approval text, exactly as approved. Do not include the Approval ID, task revision, apps list, or other approval sections. Do not shorten, revise, or summarize it. Never paste a link, a file path or a document URL in place of the description. Source URLs for input files go only in Final Notes.

Used Apps	Add every genuine app you will use to complete the task. The app list must match Studio and your approval.

`**Important: **The Task Description (Goal) and Used Apps must be correct before recording. Missing or mismatched information may cause a task to be rejected.`

Step 2. Start and Record

1. Leave the Task Description (Goal) document on screen and behind the TaskRecorder, then click the **Start Recording** button in TaskRecorder.
2. Minimize the TaskRecorder window.
3. Leave the Task Description (Goal) document window visible for a few seconds and say:

❝ I will be beginning my task soon. Here is the workflow I have in mind. ❞

1. Keep the introduction narration under 20 seconds. **DO NOT** read or explain the full Task Description (Goal).
2. Minimize or close the Task Description (Goal) document.
3. Start your task recording and complete the professional workflow while following all of the Recording Expectations.
4. **NEW:** Epilogue narration
5. **NEW** - Epilogue narration 1. **All task ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT must include an epilogue narration. Tasks whose ideas were** originally approved before this time do not need to include an epilogue narration. Later revision or reapproval does not remove this exemption. In Full Workflow, tick the epilogue checkbox for a completed required epilogue or an exempt pre-cutoff idea. The checkbox confirms either condition; do not tick it if neither is true. If an AutoQC finding is wrong, dispute it with a written reason; see Studio Workflow for the submission steps**.** 1. After the task is finished and before the expert closes the task recorder, provide a brief summary of your work, including their assessment of whether the task was completed, any relevant reflections, or any other important highlights to mention. Below are the possible questions to cover:
    1. **Completion and outcome:** How did you verify the successful completion of the task? Were there any limitations?
    2. **Approach and key decision:** What was your overall approach? Why did you choose this approach?
    3. **Challenges and problem solving:** What was the most difficult, ambiguous, or unexpected part? Did you encounter any errors or need to change your approach? How did you resolve the issue?
    4. **Quality assessment:** How would you evaluate the quality of your final result? Ar there any weaknesses or potential issues with the result?
    5. **Reflection and improvement**: If you were to do the task again, what would you do differently? If you had additional time, what would you improve or verify?
    6. **Insight:** What is one important principle, consideration, or common mistake that someone less experienced might overlook when performing this type of task?

```
. **T*arget a 3–4 minute epilogue narration, with a maximum of 4:00. Thre
. **Mouse is permitted to remain idle during the epilogue narration**
```

Step 3. Stop and Archive

1. After completing the task, save all artifacts and outputs.

2. Bring TaskRecorder to the front, then click the **Stop Recording** button.
3. Do not quit TaskRecorder while it processes the recording.
4. Wait for the status to move through **Stopping** > **Archiving** > **Idle**.

DO NOT interrupt the archiving process. Continue only after TaskRecorder displays **Idle**.

1. Click the **Show Recordings** button and locate the newest timestamped recording folder.

Step 4. Validate the Output

Locate the corresponding/newest recording_TIMESTAMP.zip and recording_TIMESTAMP folder.

DO NOT re-name, delete or modify the recording files.

Video.mp4 Verification

Open video.mp4 file

- **IMPORTANT: Open video.mp4 in QuickTime and check the beginning, middle, and end.** Confirm that it is the correct complete attempt, the picture is usable, narration and any task-relevant audio are audible, and the recording has no corruption or unexpected truncation.
- If corrupted: Upload the recording_TIMESTAMP.zip to the TR Recordings folder.
    1. This task does not qualify for submission, but submitting your failed recording may help us identify bugs.

Screenshot Verification

Open the screenshot folder and confirm that the matching recording archive contains the screenshots folder (PNG files), video.mp4, frames.jsonl, ax.jsonl, input.jsonl, processes.jsonl and recording.log. Check that video.mp4, the archive, and the task files all belong to the same recording attempt; do not mix files from different attempts.

- Divide the PNG screenshot count by the video duration in seconds.

✅ OK	❌ BAD
A 15-minute recording should contain more than 450 screenshots. More than 0.5 per recording second. Healthy captures often contain many more.	Only a few screenshots were saved Fewer than 0.5 per recording second. Do not submit. Follow steps in the FAQ to troubleshoot.

Organize Output

Organize and rename files inside Deliverables.zip using clear names:

- **Inputs:** Any original starting files prepared in advance
    - input 1, input 2, etc.
- **Intermediate Artifacts:** Any files downloaded during recording, intermediate deliverables, or work-in-progress artifacts created during the task
    - artifact 1, artifact 2, etc.
- **Final Outputs:** The final product produced by the expert
    - final output 1, final output 2, etc.

Continue in Studio

Before uploading, open Deliverables.zip and check that every input, intermediate artifact, and final output is present, correctly labeled, and readable. Confirm that the recording archive and separate video.mp4 match this same attempt. Upload Metadata.rtf separately to Studio, not inside Deliverables.zip.

After recording and files pass validation, follow Studio Workflow, Part 3 to upload the verified files and submit the task. Confirm that the status changes to Ready for Review

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- Payments
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- Narration Requirements
- Apps and Desktop
- Onscreen Presentation
- PII, Licensed Content, and AI ...

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- Golden Examples
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- Technical Issues
- FAQ
- Contacts
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✅ Workflow Checklist

Workflow Checklist

This is the most important document in this manual: Please check off every item before

submitting, this checklist will help you be most successful quickly!

Quick reference: Odin Writer Cheat Sheet (PDF)

Before Recording (Task Plan)

- **Workpuls/Insightful:** Insightful/Workpuls is running and minimized during active hourly-paid Odin work. Keep it off for eligible tasks retaining old per-task terms (Pay FAQ Q9).
- **Metadata Consistency**: The Request section of Metadata.rtf matches the Goal in TaskRecorder. Topology and Request describe the same objective, inputs, app order, methods, and outputs.
- **Input Files**: If applicable, prepare files free of private or non-public PII, CC0 or public domain sources only.
- **Input Provenance**: In Final Notes, record actual non-AI source URLs or exactly "AI-generated before recording"; complete Source of Data when applicable.

Before Recording (Prepare)

- **Storage and Power**: The Mac is connected to power and has enough free storage for the complete recording and archives.
- **Clean Workspace**: Hide personal accounts, notifications, recent files, and private information; close project materials before recording. Before you hit record, check the top-right account corner of every app you will use, your browser profile button, and your Finder sidebar for your name, photo or email.
- **Focus Mode**: Get into Do Not Disturb or "Focus mode" to avoid any notifications.
- **Minimal Background Noise**: Make sure you are recording in a quiet environment.
- **Accessibility Inspector**: Accessibility Inspector is running with its window closed.
- **UI Diversity**: Change at least one per recording; more is better: wallpaper, light or dark mode, accent color, Dock size, sidebar icon size, screen resolution, or an in-app theme.
- **Mouse cursor:** Mouse cursor size & color must stay default.
- **Recording Settings**: The selected display and resolution match Studio; TaskRecorder permissions are green, and the microphone is on.
- **Dock Visibility**: Keep the Dock visible and set it to left or right, not bottom. Automatically hide is off and indicators for open apps are on.
- **Clock Seconds**: Seconds are displayed on the menu bar clock.
- **Open Apps**: Fully launch, log in, load, open required files/workspaces; minimize to the dock.
- **Background Apps**: Quit unused apps, calls, and unnecessary background utilities; keep TaskRecorder and Accessibility Inspector running.
- **Workpuls/Insightful**: Minimize the Insightful window.
- **Task Description (Goal)**: Open the approved Goal document behind the

- **Task Description (Goal)**: Open the approved Goal document behind the TaskRecorder window.
- **Prefill TR**: Paste the approved Goal and genuine used apps in TaskRecorder.

During Recording (Record and Validate)

- **Minimize TR**: Immediately minimize TaskRecorder after clicking Start Recording.
- **Continuous Recording**: Use one uninterrupted recording from Start Recording through the saved final output and Stop Recording.
- **Brief Intro**: In under 20s, say the intro sentence, minimize or close Task Description (Goal), and begin.
- **Recording Length**: Plan for a recording, including the short intro and epilogue, that is at least 15 minutes and no more than 50:59 minutes (15:00-50:59).
- **Narration**: Narrate continuously: identify what and where, and explain why for important or non-obvious decisions; avoid vague “here” and “this”.
- **Audio Quality**: Speech is clear and synchronized with the screen; narration and any task-relevant audio are audible.
- **Audio Gap: Aim for no single silent gap over 45 seconds. A 46-60 second gap is nonblocking feedback; a gap over 60 seconds fails.**
- **No Profanity**: No profanity in narration or shown in recording.
- **No AI Use During Recording**: Show no AI interaction or policy-violating content
- **No PII**: Show no private or non-public PII or project references; follow the documented public GitHub and research-author exceptions.
- **Mouse Activity: Use the cursor naturally as a teaching pointer. Inactivity is handled as a qualitative delivery callout, not a numeric acceptance cutoff; the closing epilogue may be still.**
- **Teaching Pointer**: Point to what you describe, move naturally, and allow about one second around completed clicks so viewers can follow.
- **Limited Typing**: Keep the workflow mouse-driven and avoid long typing blocks
- **Keyboard Shortcuts**: Use visible mouse actions when practical; explain every necessary keyboard shortcut as you use it.
- **Window Management**: Keep one ordinary task window clear or arrange task windows side by side.
- **Keep TR Hidden**: TaskRecorder remains hidden during recording; only open again before stopping.

After Recording (Upload and Submit)

- **Final Output Quality**: Complete and save the promised output, then check that it is accurate, readable, and professionally usable.
- **Recording Archive**: The archive contains the screenshots folder (PNG files), video.mp4, frames.jsonl, ax.jsonl, input.jsonl, processes.jsonl and recording.log; the archive, video, and task files belong to the same attempt.
- **Video integrity**: Check the beginning, middle, and end for the correct complete task, usable picture, and audible narration.
- **All files uploaded**: Upload the unmodified recording_TIMESTAMP.zip, the separate video.mp4 and Deliverables.zip to Studio. Upload Metadata.rtf separately in Studio.
    - **Deliverables Save**: Label every input, intermediate artifact, and final output clearly, preserving the correct file extensions.
    - **Metadata Upload**: After recording, upload the completed Metadata.rtf in its separate Studio field; keep it outside Deliverables.zip.
    - **Deliverables Zip**: All task inputs, intermediate artifacts, and final outputs are included in Deliverables.zip.
    - **Archive Readability**: Open Deliverables.zip and verify that every required input, intermediate artifact, and final output is present and readable.

← Previous

Next →